

VISUAL IDENTITY & DESIGN SYSTEM

Brand Style Guide

Marketing Standards for WorkforceAP

Version 2.0 · March 2026 · Confidential

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This document defines visual and verbal standards for all WorkforceAP marketing — website, social media, collateral, presentations, and partner communications. When in doubt: use the token system, not hardcoded values.

Brand Identity

Mission, positioning, and personality.

MISSION STATEMENT

Connecting underserved adults, the organizations that serve them, and the employers that need them — in one verified closed loop.

Free to members. Employer-aligned. Outcome-accountable.

BRAND PERSONALITY

Trait	Meaning
Grounded	Show outcomes, not promises.
Direct	Plain language. No jargon.
Warm	This is someone's livelihood.
Ambitious	Infrastructure, not a charity.
Inclusive	No age gate. No degree. No exclusion.

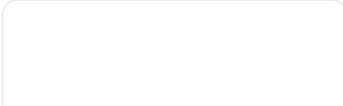
WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT

We Are	We're Not
Free to all qualifying members	Employer-sponsored only
Adults 18+ at any career stage	Recent grads only
Verified placement + 180-day tracking	Certificate mill
Full-stack AI platform	PDF worksheets

Color System

WCAG AA compliant. All backgrounds hardcoded for consistency.

PRIMARY PALETTE

			
Crimson (Accent) #AD2C4D CTAs, links, all accent uses	Gold #FFBB00 Dark bg only — fails on light	Near Black #121416 Hero bg, dark surfaces	White #FFFFFF Text on dark, light surfaces

SUPPORTING PALETTE

			
Accent Dark #8B1F38 Hover state for Crimson	Blue #2B7BB9 Links, informational states	Green #4A9B4F Success, positive metrics	On Surface Var. #584144 Secondary text, labels

✓ CRIMSON IS THE SOLE CTA COLOR

One primary action per view. Always #AD2C4D. Never swap to another color.

✗ GOLD FAILS ON LIGHT BACKGROUNDS

Gold on white = 1.7:1 contrast. Use Gold on dark (#121416) surfaces only.

✓ USE CSS TOKENS IN CODE

```
var(--color-accent) not #AD2C4D  
var(--color-gold) not #FFBB00
```

✗ NEVER USE VAR(--COLOR-WHITE) ON HERO TEXT

In dark mode, --color-white remaps to #121417 (near-black). Use literal #fff on dark overlays.

Typography

Inter is our single typeface. Hierarchy through weight and size.

Display/H1
40px · 800

Empowering People.

H2
32px · 700

Industry-Recognized Certifications

H3
24px · 700

Digital Literacy Program

Body
16px · 400 ·
1.6lh

Free career training for adults at every stage of their journey. Our programs are employer-aligned and outcome-accountable.

Small
14px · 400

Duration: 3–6 months · Cost to member: \$0 · CompTIA certified

LINE HEIGHT

Body: **1.6×**

Headings: **1.0–1.2×**

LETTER SPACING

Display: **-0.03em**

Labels: **+0.06–0.15em**

LINE WIDTH

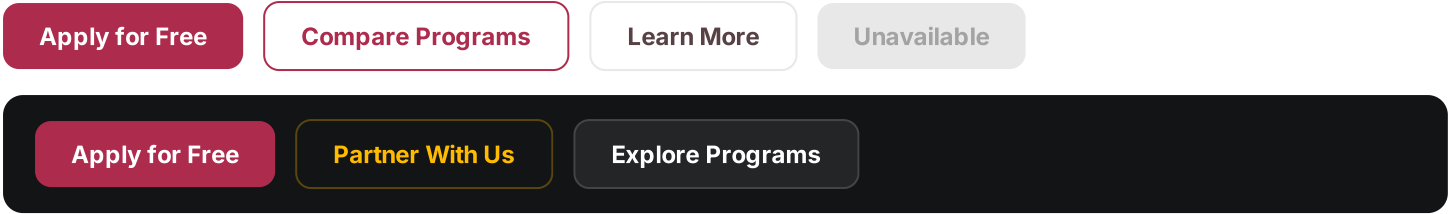
Body: **65–70 chars**

Max: **~680px**

Buttons & CTAs

One primary action per view. Specific copy.

BUTTON VARIANTS



CTA COPY RULES

✓ Write This	✗ Not This
Apply for Free	Learn More
Start My Application	Click Here
Compare Programs	Submit
Partner With Us	Explore Opportunities

BUTTON HIERARCHY

Type	When
Primary	One per screen — main conversion
Secondary	Supporting actions
Ghost	Tertiary, nav items
Gold (dark)	Secondary CTA on dark heroes only

Logo Usage

Never stretched. Never recolored. Always with clear space.



WorkforceAP
Empowering People. Advancing Future

On white / light backgrounds



WorkforceAP
Empowering People. Advancing Future

On dark / photo backgrounds



WorkforceAP
Empowering People. Advancing Future

On accent (crimson) backgrounds

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Rule	Standard
Clear Space	Min 1× height of "W" letterform on all sides
Min Size	120px wide (digital) / 1 inch (print)
On Light	Full color — crimson icon, dark wordmark
On Dark	White version — never use color logo on dark
Never	Stretch, skew, recolor, add shadow, crop below 120px

Voice & Copy

Plain. Direct. Human. Specific.

✓ DIRECT

"Apply now. We respond within 3–5 business days."

✓ SPECIFIC

"CompTIA A+, IBM AI Professional, \$62K–\$88K starting."

✗ CORPORATE

"We'd love to connect on your exciting journey forward!"

✗ VAGUE

"Industry-recognized certs in high-demand fields."

TERMINOLOGY STANDARDS

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✓ Use This	✗ Not This	Reason
Member	Student / User	Adults in a community, not students.
Free / \$0	Complimentary	Say it plainly. Asterisks create distrust.
WorkforceAP	WAP / Workforce AP	One word, camel case. Always.

Quick Reference

All rules. One page.

PRIMARY CTA COLOR

Crimson #AD2C4D — always. One per screen.

HERO TEXT

Use #fff directly on dark overlays — not `var(--color-white)`.

SPACING

8px grid. CSS tokens only — no arbitrary values.

BORDER RADIUS

Buttons: 8px · Cards: 12px · Modals: 16px.

LOGO CLEAR SPACE

1× height of 'W' on all sides. Min 120px wide.

DARK MODE CODE

Use `var()` tokens — never hardcode hex in components.

GOLD USAGE

Dark backgrounds only. Never on white/light (fails WCAG).

FONT

Inter only. Body 16px/1.6. Headings Bold 700.

CONTRAST

4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text/UI (WCAG AA minimum).

MOBILE

<640px: single column, 44px touch targets, bottom nav.

CTA COPY

"Apply for Free" > "Learn More" — specific + active voice.

TERMINOLOGY

"Member" not "student". "WorkforceAP" not "WAP".

Questions about the brand?

Design system: `workforceap-beta/css/main.css`



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Empowering People. Advancing Future.